

ET.PM3 – EFFECTIVE PRESENTATIONS (SW12)

1 Language for presenting

1. Starting off

Take advantage of these few words to “find your feet” and adapt your voice to the size of the room.

- „Good afternoon ladies and gentlemen.“ (very formal)
- „Good morning everyone. Shall we begin?“ (rather informal)
- „Good morning. It’s a pleasure to be able to speak here at the Xth conference on...“ (rather formal)

2. Stating the purpose of your talk

- „My purpose/objective today is to...“
- „What I’d like to do this afternoon is to...“
- „My talk today will deal with...“
- „My presentation this morning will concern primarily...“
- „This afternoon, I’d like to look into two topics of interest of...“
- „I’ve been invited here this morning to...“

à You might combine the purpose statement with an introduction to your subject.

„The design of electric vehicles has improved enormously in the past ten years. However, they still do not have enough autonomy. **I’m here today to present** some possible approaches to the problem.“

à Or use a rhetorical question (or other types of “attention getter”)

„Who in the field of waste management has never been confronted with the NIMBY syndrome? **My talk today will concern primarily** the ozone hole. We all know that an ozone hole has formed over Antarctica. What we don’t know is: Why?

3. The overview: presenting the structure of your talk

Give your audience a map and tools for listening. Typical forms used in this section are „will“, „going to“ and „would like to“.

Map: „I've divided my presentation into three parts.“
„I'm going to divide this talk into four parts.“
„In my presentation, I'll focus on three major issues.“

Tools: „**To begin with**, I'll be speaking about the components found in our atmosphere. **Then**, we'll examine some of the reasons for the growth in CO₂ in recent years. **After that**, I'll explain what the greenhouse effect is and how it works. **And finally**, we'll take a look at some possible consequences of the increase in temperature.

à Other forms of sequencing are:

First of all,... Next,...Finally,...
To begin with,... Then,...And finally,
First,...Second,...Third,...

4. Functions when speaking: Signposting

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|---|--|
| 1. When you want to make your next point. | <i>Let's move on to...</i> |
| 2. When you want to change direction. | <i>Now let's turn to...</i> |
| 3. When you want to deepen your analysis | <i>I'd like to elaborate on this point.</i> |
| 4. When you want to give a wider perspective. | <i>To expand on this point,...</i> |
| 5. When you want to depart from your plan. | <i>To digress for a moment,...</i> |
| 6. When you want to repeat the main points. | <i>To recap,...</i> |
| 7. When you want to give the key points. | <i>To summarize,...</i> |
| 8. When you want to finish your talk. | <i>To conclude,...</i> |

Other forms include:

„Now, what about....?“ (rhetorical question)

„Let's just recap...“ (repetition of key points)

„This leads me to the question of...“ (connecting elements)

5. Ending your presentation

The end of your presentation is your chance to make sure that the audience leaves your presentation with an understanding of the most important point you wanted to make. Don't just end after your final slide with "Thank you" or "this has been my presentation". Instead you should do one of the following:

- Summarize your key-points
- Show a take-home message, what you are concluding
- Go back to your opening questions / attention getter to create a full-circle experience

Possible statements include:

"Let's briefly summarize what we've talked about today."

"To wrap up, today we have been able to show you..."

"If there's one thing I'd like you to remember from today, it's that..."

"The key takeaway is simple: ..."

"In the beginning we asked you.... Now, after listening to our presentation, we hope....."

2 Pronunciation (sounds and stress)

1. They need to conduct a detailed an_____ of the water.
2. Such a phenomenon does not oc_____ very often.
3. The var_____ in the equation are x, y and z.
4. What are the cons_____ of a change in air temperature?
5. The f_____ of this lecture is on the theoretical background.
6. As traditional energy sources become used up, we need to find alt_____ sources of energy.
7. We do not have suf_____ information to solve the problem.
8. First, we need to formulate a hyp_____ and then we need to see if we can prove it to be true.
9. The ra_____ of men to women in the department is ten to one.
10. The book was a compr_____ study of the dynamics of heat.
11. It is wise to give pri_____ to those subjects where you are weakest.
12. His work was cruc_____ to the project's success.
13. There is a lot of contr_____ over the issue of creationism.
14. The team of dev_____ was asked to dev_____ a new software solution.